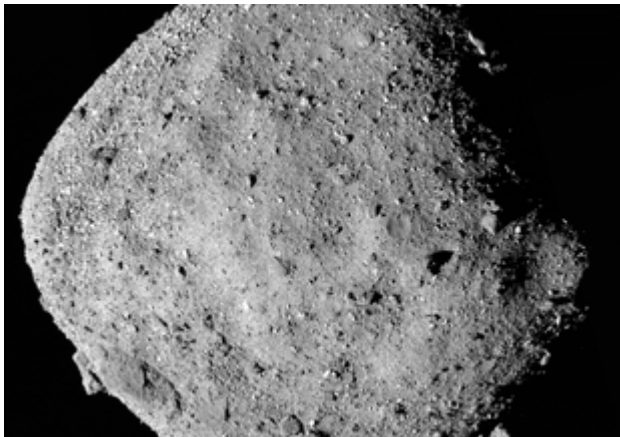
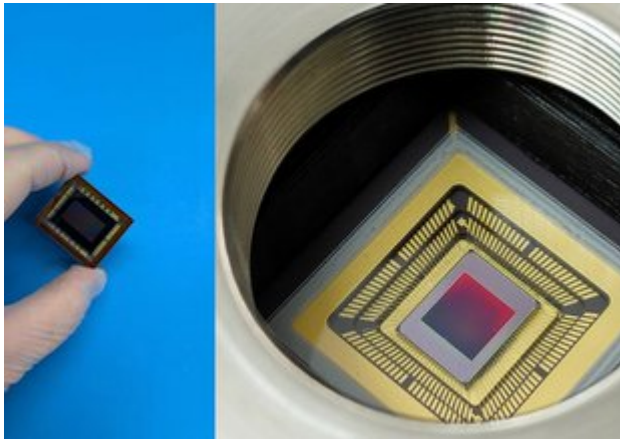


About Astrobiology







Atacama Desert, Chile The Atacama is the driest non-polar desert in the world and is a suitable analog for ancient Mars.

Deserts
Frasassi Cave Complex, Italy A cold "vent on land" hosting an isolated ecosystem powered by sulfur-cycling microorganisms.

Ancient Earth sites

Juan de Fuca Ridge The Juan de Fuca Ridge is an oceanic spreading center that supports extensive deep sea hot springs.

Hydrothermal Systems

Kilauea Crater, Hawaii Lava tubes could provide insight into environments for life on ancient Mars where lava flows created similar features.

Deep Subsurface sites

Laguna Negra, Central Andes, Chile Using Technology Relevant to Titan's Exploration to Investigate the Impact of Glacial Melt on Past and Present Planetary Lakes

Extreme Lakes

McLaughlin Natural Reserve, CA Ultra mafic rock actively undergoing

serpentinization.

Serpentinization sites

McMurdo Dry Valleys The McMurdo Dry Valleys are one of the driest and coldest deserts on Earth, and have long served as an analog site for Mars.

Antarctica

Mid Cayman Rise, Caribbean Sea Hydrothermal vent field found deep below the ocean surface, a plausible analog for habitable environments in sub-ice oceans on worlds like Europa and Enceladus.

Hydrothermal Systems

Mistaken Point, Newfoundland, Canada Located in these rocks are the oldest examples of complex life anywhere in the world. Ancient Earth sites

Moab, Utah Desert biological soil crusts are a complex consortia of microorganisms that are the primary colonizers of desert soils. Deserts

Mojave Desert, CA The temperature extremes of the Mojave is a good analog for extraterrestrial environment such as Mars. Deserts

Pilbara Craton, Western Australia Western Australia is home to some of the most ancient rocks on Earth. Ancient Earth sites

Rio Tinto, Spain Acid mine drainage site, a plausible analog for early, wet acid conditions on Mars. Highly Acidic Sites

(SURF), Lead, South Dakota Sanford Underground Research Facility (SURF), is a major research laboratory studying life underground Deep Subsurface sites

Svalbard, Norway The arctic islands of Svalbard host extreme environments for life that are suitable analogs for certain areas on Mars. Svalbard

The Cedars, Sonoma County, CA The Cedars serpentinization communities: life in an extremely inorganic environment Serpentinization sites

Transvaal Basin, South Africa The 2.5 Ga Kuruman Iron Formation is one of the largest banded iron formations in the world. Banded Iron Formations

University Valley, Antarctica Ice-cemented ground provides a suitable analog for environments found on some areas of Mars. Antarctica

West Lake Bonney, Antarctica This ice covered lake is an extreme environment for life, and is a suitable analog for sub-ice ecosystems on icy worlds. Extreme Lakes

Yellowstone National Park, Wyoming YNP hotsprings provide an ideal natural laboratory to study the relationships between energy, elements and microbial ecology. Hydrothermal Systems

